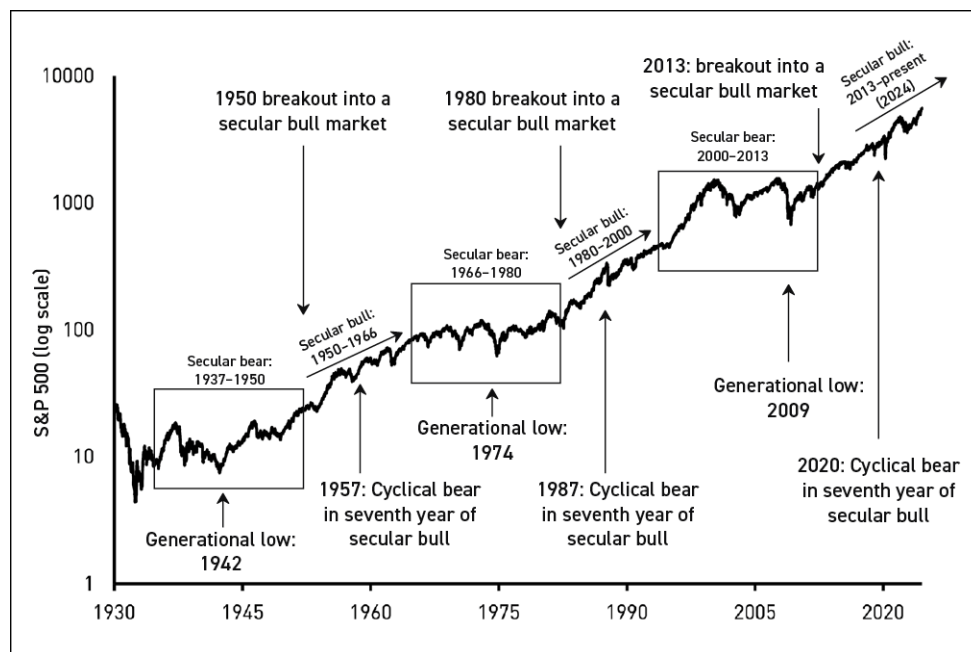


longer-term uptrends. These counter-trend moves are cyclical bears within a broader secular bull.



Consider too the three secular bear markets (boxes): 1937–1950; 1966–1982; and 2000–2013. Each involved economic weakness, geopolitical and/or social unrest, with little to no gains in corporate profitability. Again, allow me to point out the many rallies, surges, and market pops within each of these longer-term downtrends.

I have looked at dozens of other cycles, and do not find much value in them as an investor. The 10.8-year sunspot cycle¹⁸⁸ matters to farmers, as does the El Niño and La Niña. But to muni bond or index investors? Not so much.

Human lifespans are not long enough to put much stock in the theories such as Balenthiran's 17.6-year cycle, or Benner's 56-year cycle. We simply don't have enough data—or solid rational explanations—to put any weight on either.

Our current era has been driven by new technologies, ranging from mobile computing apps to fracking to materials science to mRNA, to say nothing of what AI will do. These are every bit as significant as some prior cycles (e.g., commercial aviation or electronics) with just as large ramifications.